U4 The rule of law

Unit overview

The rule of law is a fundamental principle ensuring the equal application of the law, the protection of the rights of citizens, and the preservation of social order. This unit explores the evolution of legal systems both in China and globally, with a focus on grassroots legal participation, public legal education, and the practical application of laws.

The Understanding China section examines China's local legal systems, from the Miao people's traditions to modern innovations such as online and circuit courts, which enhance legal accessibility in rural areas. It also explores the ongoing development of the rule of law, focusing on key achievements like the Hongqiao legislative contact station and the Civil Code.

The Exploring the world section provides a comparative perspective, showcasing the UK jury system and its emphasis on the role of citizens in the judicial process. This contrast helps Ss appreciate the varied approaches to legal participation across cultures.

The Communicating with the world section challenges Ss to create a publicity video that highlights China's legal advancements and their positive impact on society and individuals. This activity deepens Ss' understanding of the intersection between legal systems and social progress, fostering a global perspective on the role of law in safeguarding national development and prosperity.

思政元素清单

Understanding China — Viewing

- 学法懂法是守法用法的前提。
- 要努力让人民群众在每一个司法案件中感受到公平正义。
- 依法治国必须重视传统文化的作用，推进法治建设的同时要继承和弘扬中华优秀传统文化。

Understanding China — Reading

- 全面依法治国最广泛、最深厚的基础是人民，必须坚持为了人民、依靠人民。
- 公民直接参与立法过程，体现了“人民当家作主”的理念。
- 加快完善中国特色社会主义法律体系，以良法促进发展、保障善治。

Exploring the world — Reading

- 司法民主化是普遍追求，公民参与司法正是这一理念的重要实践。
- 法治公信力的核心在于司法透明度和程序正义。
- 公民的法律意识与和法治信仰是现代法治建设的社会基础。

单元开篇

Quote

全面依法治国是国家治理的一场深刻革命，必须坚持厉行法治，推进科学立法、严格执法、公正司法、全民守法。

——2017 年 10 月 18 日，习近平在中国共产党第十九次全国代表大会上的报告

Key facts about China

The key facts in this unit reflect China's multifaceted approach to creating a robust legal system. They highlight efforts to ensure participation in the lawmaking process, maintain public security, and promote legal education. Together, these data suggest a legal system that is not only focused on governance but also on shaping societal values. T can guide Ss to access the digital textbook for the latest information and data. Here's how the selected key facts connect to the quote:

Key fact 1: This fact reflects a strong sense of law and order in China. This could be attributed to a combination of factors, including effective law enforcement, stringent security measures, and a generally high level of public compliance with laws. The high public security index underscores China's reputation for being a safe and stable country.

Key fact 2: This fact reflects a maturing legal system that prioritizes quality over mere quantity. These laws are well-crafted and aligned with high-quality development goals, supporting governance, innovation, and social stability. This evolution reinforces the rule of law as a core foundation of China's modern development.

Key fact 3: With nearly 92 percent of enacted / amended laws (156 out of 170) incorporating grassroots feedback since 2015, this fact reflects a bottom-up approach to lawmaking, which enhances the legitimacy and inclusiveness of China's legal system.

Key fact 4: This fact demonstrates a strategic push to improve legal literacy across China, aligning with the government's commitment to fostering a culture of rule of law across all sections of society.

***T can guide Ss to access the digital textbook for the latest information and data on Ucampus.**

Teaching suggestions

Step 1: Begin by asking Ss to reflect on the meaning of the "rule of law" and its function in different societies. Use the quote to stimulate discussion. T can ask follow-up questions like "Why is 'advancing law-based governance' called a 'profound revolution'?" T can also show the Nanjing Constitution Park image and ask questions like: How do public spaces like this promote the rule of law?

Step 2: Divide Ss into small groups to review and discuss the significance of key facts about China's legal system. T can link Ss' findings to "sound lawmaking / strict enforcement" in the quote.

Step 3: Introduce Scenario and ask Ss to brainstorm legal practices that impact their daily life in China.

Step 4: Present the unit's learning objectives and explain how this unit enhances Ss' understanding of China's legal system. Highlight how the unit fosters cross-cultural understanding by comparing legal systems in China with those in other parts of the world, helping Ss develop a more comprehensive perspective on modern legal practices.

Understanding China

The video and reading materials in this section offer a rich exploration of China's evolving legal system, focusing on grassroots participation and innovative legal practices. The video highlights localized efforts in Rongshui, Guangxi, to make legal processes more accessible through initiatives like mock trials, remote mediation, and circuit courts in rural areas. These efforts exemplify the commitment to ensuring equal access to justice for all citizens. Similarly, the reading material discusses grassroots involvement in lawmaking through national-level legislative contact stations and the Civil Code's response to society's evolving needs.

Both materials showcase China's commitment to a people-centered legal system. The teaching focus for this unit should center on the concepts of legal accessibility and public participation, while the difficulty lies in enabling Ss to critically assess how these reforms are aligned with the broader principles of justice and legal evolution. The challenge for Ss is to understand how China integrates modern legal practices with traditional values and addresses contemporary societal issues.

Viewing

Before viewing

Teaching suggestions

The four definitions of law in Activity 1 (P81) of the Students' Book demonstrate different perspectives drawn from philosophy, sociology, legal theory, and modern practice. They are intended to help Ss understand that law is not a single concept, but one that varies depending on its purpose, function, or historical background. T can use these definitions to guide classroom discussion, enabling Ss to deepen understanding and relate abstract ideas to real-world examples.

A. Law is a rule of conduct, a contract, an ideal of reason.

This definition reflects classical natural law theory, influenced by thinkers like Aristotle and Thomas Aquinas. Law is not merely a set of rules, but a guide for behavior, a moral contract among people, and a rational ideal grounded in justice.

T can encourage Ss to see law as more than punishment – a system rooted in ethics and reason.

B. Law is a form of social control.

Attributed to Plato, this view emphasizes law's role in maintaining social order. Law regulates behavior, prevents conflict, and reinforces societal norms.

T can use real-life examples (e.g., traffic rules, school policies) to help Ss understand how law shapes daily life.

C. Law is a rule of civil conduct prescribed by the supreme power in a state, commanding what is right and prohibiting what is wrong.

This legal positivist definition is associated with William Blackstone. It defines

law as authoritative commands from the state, intended to regulate civil behavior and enforce moral boundaries.

T can introduce Ss to the formal structure of law – where authority, power, and enforcement are central.

D. Law consists of enforceable rules governing relationships among individuals and between individuals and their society.

This modern, functional definition appears in many legal textbooks. Law is seen as a system of enforceable rules that define rights, regulate relationships, and balance private and public interests.

T can use familiar examples like contracts, property rights, or consumer laws to show how law operates in daily life.

Sample answers

1

I personally think D makes the most sense. This definition captures the essence of law in a more comprehensive and practical way, highlighting not only its role in governing interactions between people but also its enforceability, which is key to its effectiveness.

My own definition of law would be: **Law is a system of rules established by authorities to regulate behavior, resolve disputes, and protect rights within a society**. This definition encompasses the functions of law – guiding behavior, resolving conflicts, and protecting rights – while also implying that law is grounded in legitimate authority and informed by societal needs and values, which are crucial for its legitimacy.

2

I think B and C are the most effective ways to spread legal knowledge.

- **B** is effective because it provides a direct and personal way for people to learn from experienced professionals who can explain complex legal concepts clearly. It also allows for interaction and discussion, which helps deepen understanding.
- **C** is effective because media and entertainment products like TV programs and dramas can reach a wider audience and make legal concepts more relatable. Through storytelling, people can see how laws are applied in real-life situations, making it easier to understand their relevance and importance.

Alternatively**,** I think A and D are the most effective ways to spread legal knowledge.

- **A** is effective because it reaches a broad audience in everyday settings. Slogans are short and memorable, making key legal concepts easy to understand and

remember. Brochures can provide more detailed information in a simple, visually engaging format. This method is especially useful in communities with limited access to online or formal legal education. However, it works best when combined with other interactive or media-based approaches.

- **D** is a fun and engaging way to promote legal awareness, especially among students and young people. They encourage participants to actively study laws and understand their rights and responsibilities. When held in schools or communities, they can create a positive learning atmosphere and increase interest in legal topics.

In addition to traditional methods, there are several innovative ways to popularize legal knowledge:

- Social media campaigns for younger audiences
- Community legal clinics / street law programs offering free legal advice directly to the public
- School curriculum integration for early awareness of rights and responsibilities
- Online platforms / mobile apps offer convenient access to legal information
- National campaigns like Constitution Day
- Interactive tools (quizzes / mock trials)
- These diverse approaches help make legal knowledge more accessible, practical, and relevant to everyday life.

Scripts

[Anchor]: I found these pictures in the materials. It looks like they are just ordinary stones. There is no text. A long time ago, in order to establish township regulations and resolve disputes, the Miao people buried them in places where land disputes existed, in this way to endow the authority of the regulations, similar to the Hammurabi of ancient Babylon. Hundreds of years have passed, but what does it look like now? What do they rely on to resolve problems now?

I came to Rongshui, Guangxi, where the Miao people live. I hope to find my answer here.

Scene 1

[Student]: Please be quiet. The court is ready for session. Public prosecutor, legal representatives, and defense attorney are invited to appear in court.

[Anchor]: The Rongshui Miao Autonomous County People's Juvenile Criminal Moot Court is now in session. Defendant, his representatives, and his attorney….

I was riveted. It felt like I was in a real trial. The students were so professional. It (the moot court) turned the law, which can be very abstract, into something that's easy to follow and easy to understand. This is just one of the examples of how we can

popularize the law more and more to all the members of society by actually making it accessible.

Scene 2

[Staff]: Today I will show you around the Rongshui Court. Please follow me. This is our Shared Remote Mediating Room. This is Wangdong People's Court.

[Anchor]: Good morning, your honor.

[Judge]: Good morning!

[Anchor]: Engaging in a lawsuit is a complicated process. But the new lawsuit service reduces so much of the stress related to it. You can still get all the legal benefits you deserve without having to spend so much time and money. It improves the efficiency of law enforcement for everyone.

So, have you used the new lawsuit service yet? And what do you think about it?

[Interviewee A]: I think this online court service is of great help to the people. I don't even need to go out to keep abreast of my case.

[Interviewee B]: We are getting better now, as we are protected by law.

[Interviewee C]: Now we know more about the law.

[Anchor]: And how has the new lawsuit service changed your life?

[Interviewee D]: Now in our countryside, the service is the same as in the city, very convenient and efficient. Just three words: It is great!

Scene 3

[Anchor]: I wonder what the judge is doing with that emblem and where he's going with it. Excuse me, sir! Where are you going?

[Judge]: We are going to the countryside to handle cases.

[Anchor]: I would love to see that. Can I come with you?

[Judge]: OK!

[Anchor]: Why do you take the emblem with you when you handle cases in the countryside?

[Judge]: The national emblem is what we must carry on the circuit. Because it represents authority and justice. When we handle cases in the circuit trial mode, usually, we can only set up simple courts. But we still need to honor the authority of the law. So, no matter where we go, we will carry the national emblem.

[Anchor]: It looks like it's a lot of effort to come all the way here, and far distances to travel. Why do you set up courts like this?

[Judge]: We took the initiative to bring the court to the people's homes. The first reason is for the convenience of the local residents, to help them save time and money. The second reason is that, in our jurisdiction, people's knowledge of the law is relatively

poor. When we set up the court at their homes to help them out, we are also enhancing their legal knowledge to some extent and improving their legal literacy. That's why we took the initiative of setting up courts in people's homes.

[Anchor]: So, what kind of cases do you usually handle?

[Judge]: Every year there are divorce disputes, private lending disputes, and disputes among neighbors. Cases in these three categories are about the same numbers.

[Anchor]: And how many cases are roughly taken here?

[Judge]: Our circuit court handles about 400 cases a year.

[Anchor]: The (circuit court) judges certainly are very different to what I'm used to. They kind of make me think of legal superheroes carrying their emblem through the rain and the misty mountains to get to the people and serve them justice who otherwise probably wouldn't be able to access it.

Our trip here has been very interesting. We got to participate in a mock trial. We saw all the ways that technology is making it easier to access the law. And we even got to observe a circuit court in a small village. Nowadays, there are more and more ways of popularizing the law and enforcing it efficiently. The law is not just some abstract thing that's only relevant to legal professionals. It's all around us. It influences all of us. The improvement of the legal system continues to enhance people's sense of satisfaction. And I believe better access to law and raising awareness of the law will create a better and happier society.

Notes

Hammurabi of ancient Babylon refers to the Code of Hammurabi, issued by Hammurabi, a king of ancient Babylon, during the 18th century BC. It is also known as the "Stele Code," due to its inscription on a black stone. It was once considered the oldest known set of written laws in human history, though older, shorter law collections have since been found. It contains 282 laws addressing civil, criminal, and commercial matters.

Language points

1 The court is ready for session. Public Prosecutor, Legal Representatives, and Defense Attorney are invited to appear in court. (Scene 1)

session: *n.* [C] a formal meeting or group of meetings, esp. of a law court or parliament （法庭的）开庭

The judge announced that the court was ready for session after a brief delay.

appear: *vi.* go to a law court or other official meeting to give information, answer questions, etc. 出庭；出席

Witnesses were summoned to appear in court to provide testimony.

Note: "Appear in court" is a formal phrase typically used in legal settings. It implies that someone is physically present in court for a legal proceeding but can also refer to participating virtually in some modern court systems (e.g., video conference hearings).

2 This is just one of the examples of how we can popularize the law more and more to all the members of society by actually making it accessible. (Scene 1)

popularize: *vt*. make a difficult subject or idea able to be easily understood by ordinary people who have no special knowledge about it 使普及；使通俗化
We need to popularize sustainable practices in every community to ensure environmental protection.

accessible: *a*. easy to obtain or use 可使用的；可及的
Nowadays, AI apps are accessible to a large number of people around the world, though some may still face barriers.

3 I don't even need to go out to keep abreast of my case. (Scene 2)

keep / stay abreast of sth.: make sure that you know all the most recent facts or information about a particular subject or situation 了解某事的最新情况
Lawyers must keep abreast of changing regulations to provide the best counsel.

Note: This phrase is often used in professional or formal settings to discuss the importance of remaining informed about something. It suggests a proactive approach to keeping up-to-date with the developments in one's field, often in law, business, and academia. It can be used in less formal contexts too, though with a slightly more elevated tone.

4 That's why we took the initiative of setting up courts in people's homes. (Scene 3)

take the initiative: if you take the initiative in a situation, you are the first person to act, and are therefore able to control the situation 主动；带头
The company took the initiative to launch a new environmental campaign.

Note: This phrase conveys a sense of leadership, independence, and proactive behavior. In both professional and social contexts, it suggests someone who is ready to act and take charge of a situation, often without waiting for others to act first.

Viewing and understanding

Reference answers

2

1 T

2 F

[Corrected: The Rongshui Miao Autonomous County People's Juvenile Criminal Moot Court is a mock court designed for educational purposes.]

3 T

5 F

[Corrected: The new lawsuit service allows people to manage their cases online, reducing the need for frequent travel to court.]

5 T

6 T

6 F

[Corrected: Circuit courts in the countryside handle various types of disputes, including divorce, private lending, and neighbor disputes.]

7 F

[Corrected: The video suggests that the law is relevant to everyone, not just legal professionals, and it influences all aspects of life.]

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

This activity aims to develop Ss' skills in crafting engaging, curiosity-driven, and guiding questions for creating an impactful publicity video on China's rule of law and its positive influence on people's lives.

- **Introduce the three types of questions**:
  - Curiosity-driven questions should spark the audience's interest by addressing themes that resonate with their experiences or curiosity.
  - Relatable questions should invite personal responses or shared experiences, helping the audience connect with the subject matter.
  - Guiding questions ensure the narrative remains focused and progresses logically.

It's important that the questions are balanced, allowing flexibility while still maintaining clarity.

- **Give a brief overview of the project context**:
  - Ss are tasked with creating a video to demonstrate China's legal advancements and their positive influence.
  - Emphasize that the questions should be tailored to international students, ensuring the content is understandable and relatable to viewers unfamiliar with the Chinese legal system.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

3

Group topic: Legal reforms in China's rural areas

Curiosity-driven questions:

- How have legal aid services made a difference in rural areas?
- What were the main challenges before the legal reforms, and how have they been addressed?
- Why is access to justice crucial for rural areas?

Relatable questions:

- How has the legal process become more accessible to ordinary people like you?
- Can you share a personal story or example where improved legal services benefited you or someone you know in the countryside?

Guiding questions:

- What are the main features of China's legal reforms in rural areas?
- How have these reforms improved the lives of farmers and workers in rural areas?

Reading

Text: Law on our doorstep

Background information

The rule of law is essential for building a modern socialist country, ensuring the protection of rights and social stability. The rule of law is viewed not only as a mechanism for governance but as a tool for fostering fairness, justice, and accountability in society. The rule of law in China goes beyond merely enacting laws; it involves comprehensive reforms in governance, legal education, judicial independence, and public participation in the legal process. This is exemplified in the text by grassroots involvement through legislative contact stations and the modernization of laws, such as the Civil Code.

In line with the modernization of its legal system, China has introduced technological advancements to improve judicial efficiency and accessibility. These innovations include online courts, AI-powered legal tools, and digital platforms for public participation. Since 2017, China has established online courts to make legal proceedings more accessible, especially for citizens in remote areas. This initiative has greatly reduced the cost and time associated with legal processes, making justice more efficient. Additionally, China has invested in AI tools to assist with legal research, case analysis, and even the drafting of legal documents.

The overall aim of these legal advancements is to enhance the daily lives of Chinese people by providing greater access to justice, ensuring social stability, and addressing emerging societal challenges.

Notes

Laws, **regulations**, **acts**, **guidance**, and **policies** are terms that are often used interchangeably in casual contexts, but they have distinct legal meanings. **Acts** are primary legislation enacted by national or regional legislatures, establishing fundamental legal frameworks. **Laws** encompass both acts and subsidiary rules, enforceable by courts, enforceable through judicial mechanisms. **Regulations** are detailed implementation rules issued by executive bodies under legislative delegation. **Guidance** offers recommendations on how to comply with regulations, but it is not enforceable. **Policies**, set by organizations or governments, outline expected behaviors and goals, often supported by laws. The key differences between the terms include the scope, enforceability, and origin, with laws and acts being legally binding, unlike guidance and policies.

***T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 In the sweltering summer heat of Shanghai, a small room in the Gubei Civic Center buzzes with heated discussion. (Para. 1)

buzz: *vi*. (~ **with**) be full of excitement, activity, etc. 充满兴奋（或活动等）
The office buzzes with excitement *ahead of the big presentation.*

Note: "Buzz with" is a figurative phrase that creates a vivid image of a place alive with energy or movement. It's particularly useful in describing places or situations where there is a lot of conversation, action, or emotional energy. In this context, the phrase suggests a high-energy environment with intense discussion or activity.

2 The fervor of the debate mirrors the oppressive heat outside as participants grapple with the pressing question … (Para. 1)

mirror: *vt.* if one thing mirrors another, it is very similar to it and may seem to copy or represent it 与…相似
His calm demeanor mirrors that of his father, who is always composed in difficult situations.

Note: "Mirror" is often used metaphorically to suggest that one thing reflects or closely corresponds to another, indicating a parallel or similarity. It is commonly used in both literal (reflections in a mirror) and figurative (ideas, behaviors, or conditions) contexts.

grapple with: try hard to deal with or understand sth. difficult 尽力解决，设法理解（难题）
She grapples with the decision of whether to move abroad or stay in her hometown.

3 Every citizen can roll up their sleeves and engage in the process of making or amending the law, truly taking ownership. (Para. 2)

roll up one's sleeves: start doing a job, even though it is difficult 卷起袖子（准备苦干）

If we want to improve the community, we need to roll up our sleeves and start working together.

Note: This phrase is often used in informal settings to suggest someone is ready to work or face challenges. It invokes a sense of readiness and a hands-on approach. This phrase is especially effective when encouraging someone to take personal initiative. Similar expressions include "get involved" and "take action."

4 I thought the legislative contact station would be tucked away in a grand, secluded building or an office tower. (Para. 2)

be tucked away: be located in a quiet place, where not many people go 坐落在，位于（僻静的地方）

The library was tucked away in a corner of the campus.

Note: The key expressions "tucked away," "grand," and "secluded" highlight the connotations of spaces in different contexts. These words show how legislative systems are viewed in different cultures. The idea of a "secluded" or "grand" building contrasts sharply with the transparency and public engagement seen in the legislative contact stations.

5 In addition to involving ordinary citizens, China has also made great strides in enacting new laws to deal with novel issues arising from the rapid development of society. (Para. 4)

make great strides: make significant progress or advances 取得巨大进步

The country has made great strides in improving healthcare over the last decade.

Note: This phrase emphasizes progress and is often used in formal or academic contexts to highlight positive developments. It's a stronger expression than simply saying "made progress," implying a considerable or notable improvement.

enact: *v.* make a proposal into a law 制定，通过，颁布（法令）

The government is focused on enacting stricter laws to protect the environment.

Note: This word is used primarily in legal and legislative contexts; "enacting" refers to the formal process of passing laws. It carries a sense of official action and authority.

Note: This transitional sentence shifts the focus from grassroots legislative participation to China's broader legislative achievements, especially the Civil Code. It marks a textual pivot from "who participates in lawmaking" to "what laws are being made and why," showing the dual emphasis on public engagement and modern legislative responsiveness in China's rule of law development.

6 The Civil Code has stepped up to clamp down on such dangers by holding property management companies accountable for keeping pedestrians safe. (Para. 5)

clamp down on: take strong action to stop or limit a harmful or unwanted activity 取缔；严禁；压制

Universities now clamp down on plagiarism with AI detection tools.

Note: This phrase is commonly used in legal or regulatory contexts to indicate the enforcement of rules or the application of stricter measures. It suggests a determined and often forceful effort to control or eliminate a problem.

hold sb. accountable for sth.: make sb. responsible for what they do and demand a satisfactory reason for it 要…负责；要…作出解释

The company will be held accountable for any environmental damage caused by its operations.

Note: This is commonly used in legal, professional, or ethical discussions to ensure that individuals or organizations take responsibility for their actions. It suggests that failure to meet obligations will lead to consequences.

7 If the French Civil Code symbolized the windmill and watermill era of the 19th century, and the German Civil Code represented the industrial age, then China's Civil Code is the definitive legal framework for the 21st-century Internet and high-tech era. (Para. 6)

Note: The sentence uses a conditional structure ("If ... then ...") to compare the Civil Codes of France, Germany, and China, linking each to a historical period. This structure is often used to present hypothetical scenarios, draw comparisons, or offer contrasts. Metaphors like "the windmill and watermill era" and "the industrial age" visually reinforce legal evolution, making abstract concepts more tangible. This rhetorical device underscores how legal systems adapt to technological and societal change.

8 For instance, it includes provisions for the protection of personal data in the digital age, a feature not found in many other civil codes. (Para. 6)

provision: *n.* [C] a condition in an agreement or law 规定

The law has provisions that ensure equal pay for equal work.

Note: In the context of legal discussions, "provisions" are used to describe specific clauses within laws or regulations.

9 It's a dynamic framework that adapts to the challenges of the new era by protecting rights and maintaining order while staying true to the enduring principles of justice and fairness. (Para. 7)

Meaning: It's a flexible system that evolves to meet the challenges of the modern world by safeguarding rights and maintaining social order, all while staying faithful to the timeless values of justice and fairness.

Note: In this sentence, the vocabulary and concepts, such as “framework,” “adapts to,” “maintaining order,” and “justice”, are also applicable in fields like political science, philosophy, and sociology. Ss can use these phrases when discussing changes in laws or policies or when debating global issues related to law, technology, or ethics.

10 **As China strides into a new phase, this robust legal system lights the way, guiding the nation through uncharted waters, forging the path of the rule of law, and offering its people a thriving and safe future. (Para. 7)**

Note: “Light the way” and “uncharted waters” are both metaphorical expressions. These metaphors serve to create vivid imagery, allowing readers to conceptualize the abstract ideas of change and progress. These types of expressions are useful for adding impact and making the text more engaging.

Translation

法律就在我们身边

1 在上海炎热的夏季，古北市民中心的一个小房间内人们正热火朝天地讨论着。辩论的热度与室外的酷暑交相呼应。参与者们正热烈探讨一个迫切的问题：失亲儿童应该由谁照顾？这并非一场普通的聚会，而是在虹桥街道的国家级基层立法联系点举行的讨论。普通市民在这里汇聚一堂，共同为国家法律的制定建言献策。

2 类似的场景在虹桥立法联系点屡见不鲜。参与讨论的一位市民自豪地说道：“法律可能看起来很遥远，但实际上，它就在我们身边。每一位公民都可以撸起袖子，参与到法律的制定或修订过程中，真正当家作主。”立法联系点就位于街头，欢迎市民自由参与。一位来自美国的访问代表对这种开放性表示惊讶，评论道：“我本以为立法联系点应该隐藏在某个宏伟的、隐蔽的建筑或写字楼中，但它竟然就在街边。如果我没亲眼看到，真是不敢相信。”

3 虹桥立法联系点是当前 45 个国家级立法联系点的一个缩影，它帮助表达民众的关切，将他们的愿望编织进充满活力的民主立法画卷中。这些联系点与日益壮大的地方联系点网络共同作用，像溪流汇入浩瀚大河，借助生动的座谈会、坦诚的访谈和深入的实地调研，收集民意涓流，并使其奔涌向前。它们已成为重要的信息源，确保普通民众的声音不仅被听到，而且能够迅速体现在国家法律中，推动中国法律向更广泛的公众参与发展。

4 除了让普通市民参与立法，中国还在制定新法律方面取得了显著进展，以应对社会快速发展带来的新问题。这些法律涉及国家安全、公共卫生、生态环境等关键问题，为信息时代设定了标准，并维护了伦理价值。其中，最为突出的法律之一便是《民法典》——中国首部正式命名为“法典”的法律。

5 《中华人民共和国民法典》于 2021 年颁布，是对现行民事法律、法规及司法解释的全面汇编。它常被誉为“社会生活百科全书”，为当今许多紧迫问题提供了明确的解决方案。比如，公共交通上的不文明行为，如乘客占用不属于自己的座位，《民法典》明确将这种行为定为非法，从而维护了公共交通秩序与安全。你是否曾担心走在街上时，可能被从楼上掉落的物体砸伤？《民法典》通过要求物业管理公司为行人的安全负责，加大力度遏制此类风险。那么关于七十年住宅建设用地使用权到期后的担忧呢？《民法典》确定了自动续期的规定。通过解决这些社会热点问题，《民法典》全面保障公民的权利，已成为我们日常生活中不可或缺的重要组成部分。

6 《民法典》不仅反应民众的诉求，还响应着时代节奏的变化。如果法国《民法典》象征着 19 世纪风车和水磨时代，德国《民法典》代表着工业时代，那么中国的《民法典》则是 21 世纪互联网和高科技时代的标志性法律框架。它应对信息时代技术爆炸带来的挑战，例如，它包括了数字时代对个人数据保护的条款，这在许多其他民法典中并没有体现。同时，它还回应了环境保护和生态保护等问题，倡导建设一个人与自然和谐共生的现代社会。

7 中国的法律体系不仅仅是一套法律条文，它是一股活跃且不断发展的力量，与国家的脉搏同频共振。从城市的繁忙街道到乡村的宁静角落，这一体系赋予公民积极参与制定治理其生活的法律的权利。这是一个动态的框架，它通过保护权利和维持秩序应对新时代的挑战，同时坚持正义和公平这一永恒原则。随着中国迈入新阶段，这一强大的法律体系为国家照亮前行的道路，引领着中国穿越未知的领域，开辟法治之路，为人民提供一个繁荣且安全的未来。

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) making or amending the law
2) public involvement
3) the rapid development of society
4) civil life
5) the times
6) the technological explosion
7) humans and nature coexist harmoniously
8) shaping the laws
9) justice and fairness

2

1

The Hongqiao legislative contact station exemplifies China's achievements in law popularization and public participation in several ways:

- **Accessibility and openness:** The station is located right on the street, inviting ordinary citizens to participate in discussions about laws that affect their lives. This accessibility contrasts with the perception of legislative processes being distant and bureaucratic.
- **Citizen engagement:** The vibrant debates held at the station, such as discussions on who should care for orphaned children, show that citizens are actively engaged in shaping legislation. This reflects a grassroots approach where the voices of the community are not just acknowledged but are integral to the lawmaking process.
- **Representation of public opinion:** The contact station acts as a conduit for public concerns to be communicated to lawmakers. It collects opinions through seminars and interviews, ensuring that citizens' needs and issues are reflected in national legislation.

Overall, the Hongqiao legislative contact station illustrates a dynamic and participatory legal framework that empowers citizens, demonstrating China's commitment to incorporating public input into governance.

2

China's Civil Code differs from earlier civil codes, like the French and German codes, by its responsiveness to the modern digital age and its comprehensive coverage of contemporary issues. While the French Civil Code represents the agricultural era and the German Civil Code reflects the industrial age, China's Civil Code is tailored to the 21st-century Internet and high-tech era. It addresses challenges unique to this era, such as personal data protection, which is a critical concern in today's information-driven society.

Additionally, the Civil Code includes specific provisions for environmental protection and ecological conservation, emphasizing the need for sustainable development – a focus not explicitly detailed in earlier codes. This forward-looking approach reflects a legal framework that is not only about regulating civil life but also about promoting a harmonious relationship between humans and nature.

3

The Civil Code represents a landmark achievement in China's legislative progress, reflecting the country's ability to adapt its legal framework to contemporary societal needs. Here are key points illustrating its significance:

- **Comprehensive coverage:** The Civil Code compiles existing laws related to civil life, making it a comprehensive resource for citizens. It addresses everyday issues such as misconduct on public transport and liability for high-altitude object throwing injuries, providing clear legal guidance that affects daily life.

- **Modern relevance:** Tailored to the challenges of the 21st century, the Civil Code includes provisions for personal data protection, highlighting the importance of privacy and security in an increasingly online world – a feature lacking in many other civil codes.
- **Upholding rights and responsibilities:** By instituting rules for the automatic renewal of residential land use rights and placing responsibilities on building managers for public safety, the Civil Code balances individual rights with social responsibilities. This approach fosters a shared sense of accountability among both citizens and public officials.
- **Environmental considerations:** The Civil Code also addresses ecological issues, emphasizing the need for environmental protection and conservation. This demonstrates an awareness of the interconnectedness of human and environmental health, promoting sustainable development.

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

The following teaching steps provide a structured way for developing cross-cultural comparison skills, moving from conceptual understanding to applied practice. It's especially helpful for Ss who may have limited exposure to comparative perspectives. Where appropriate, alternative approaches – such as using case studies, visual aids, or interactive discussions – are suggested to accommodate different learning styles and classroom dynamics.

- Start by explaining the concept of cross-cultural comparison to the class. Clarify that this method helps Ss understand and evaluate similarities and differences between cultures, systems, or practices. Emphasize that it's particularly useful in discussions about law, politics, and societal values because it promotes mutual understanding, respect, and appreciation of diversity.
- Tell Ss that to make a successful cross-cultural comparison, they must identify specific elements to compare. For example, they might compare the concept of individual rights or property laws in China, France, and Germany.
- Remind Ss that when making a comparison between, for example, legal systems, it's essential to consider the historical and societal context behind each system.
- Have Ss work in pairs to share and discuss their comparisons.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

China's smart court system exemplifies its commitment to judicial accessibility. A landmark achievement is the Hangzhou Internet Court, which pioneered fully digital

trials – from case filing to enforcement – using blockchain for evidence preservation. This mirrors global efforts like the European e-Justice Portal's push for digitalization, but China's model uniquely emphasizes domestic efficiency through end-to-end automation, whereas the EU focuses on multilingual interoperability for cross-border cases. This reflects the different context of the two systems: the vast population base in China versus the regional integration needs in Europe.

Language in focus

Reference answers

1

1 1 amend

2 upholding

3 safeguard

4 governing

5 compilation

6 mighty

7 Civilized

8 expired

2

1 held accountable for

2 grappling with

3 Tucked away

4 roll up their sleeves

5 clamp down on

6 buzzed with

3

In the new era, legislative work embodies the values of fairness and justice. It transforms the fundamental issues that reflect the interests of the broadest masses of the people and their aspirations for a better life into concrete objectives of the rule of law through legal language. Law enforcement, as the link in the entire rule of law chain most closely connected to people's daily lives, provides the public with the most direct and tangible experiences and perceptions of fairness and justice. Law enforcers must always uphold the belief in serving the people. Fairness and justice must be both "visible" and "perceptible," ensuring that the public can feel fairness and justice in every judicial case they experience.

Critical thinking

Sample answers

- In addition to the Miao people's use of stones to symbolize authority, another ancient Chinese tradition that reflects legal thinking is the concept of *li* (礼), which refers to propriety, manners, and ethics. In traditional Chinese society, *li* was essential in maintaining social order and regulating behavior. It functioned as a moral code governing relationships, including those between rulers and subjects, and emphasized harmony and respect. This approach to regulating social interactions through a set of moral and ethical guidelines can be seen as a precursor to formal legal principles in China.
- In modern times, China has made significant strides in legal education and legislation. For example, the establishment of the unified National Legal Profession Qualification Exam system, which certifies legal professionals in China, has helped ensure that the judiciary is staffed by qualified and well-trained individuals. Another significant example is the introduction of the Civil Code in 2021, which codifies personal rights, property rights, and family law in a comprehensive manner, representing a major advancement in the legal framework.
- Ancient legal traditions and ideas in China continue to shape modern society in important ways. These influences come from both moral philosophy and legal institutions. On the moral side, Confucian ideas like filial piety (孝) and *li* emphasize social harmony, duty to family, and respect for the elderly. These values are still seen in today's laws about family responsibilities, care for the elderly, and social behavior. In China, moral expectations often work alongside legal rules to guide people's actions. At the same time, legalist traditions also play a key role. During the Warring States Period, Shang Yang's reforms introduced the idea that laws should apply equally to everyone, regardless of status. His famous act of "Establishing one's credibility by rewarding people for moving a log (徙木立信)" showed how law was used to build government authority. Later, the Qin and Han dynasties developed written laws, standard legal procedures, and centralized enforcement – traditions that continue in modern China's focus on legal codification and state governance. Together, these time-honored traditions – both moral and legal – help shape a modern Chinese legal system that blends ethical values with systematic laws to serve a rapidly modernized society.

Exploring the world

This section presents a personal account of jury duty in the UK, highlighting the juror's role in the judicial process. The narrative emphasizes the seriousness with which citizens undertake their responsibilities, shedding light on the complexities of the UK's jury system. While the UK emphasizes citizen participation in the judicial process through jury duty, China highlights grassroots involvement in legislative practices as demonstrated in the Hongqiao legislative contact station discussed in Understanding China. This link between the two sections allows for a comparative analysis of two legal systems that place a strong emphasis on public participation, albeit in different forms.

The teaching focus of this section is to help Ss understand how both systems–jury duty in the UK and legislative participation in China–engage citizens in their respective legal processes. The primary challenge is guiding Ss to see how these systems, despite cultural and structural differences, share common values such as fairness, accountability, and the involvement of ordinary people in shaping justice. This provides an opportunity for cross-cultural exchange, where Ss can reflect on how diverse legal systems embody the universal ideals of justice, equity, and civic responsibility.

Text: Behind the scenes of justice – my experience as a juror

Background information

This text provides a first-person narrative about an individual's experience serving as a juror in a court trial. The narrator begins by describing receiving a summons for jury duty and concludes with reflections on the personal transformation that occurs through the process of jury service. The text explores several key aspects of the jury system in the UK, such as the random selection process, the potential challenges of jury duty, and the deep moral and ethical considerations that jurors face when reaching a verdict. The modern jury system took shape in 12th-century England and later spread through the British Empire. Today, the jury system remains most actively used in the United States.

The text offers a unique perspective, taking the reader from the initial reluctance of being selected for jury duty to a newfound respect for the justice system. Key moments of the narrative involve the juror's shift in perspective from external judgment based on media influence to a more evidence-based approach during deliberations.

Jury duty is a civic responsibility in many countries. Understanding the role of jurors is important for Ss, as it highlights judicial fairness and peer involvement in legal decision-making. The text offers an opportunity to discuss civic duty and social responsibility. Jurors are required to set aside personal biases and follow the law as presented in court. This can be linked to broader discussions on ethics and the rule of law. The text also delves into the emotional challenges jurors face when making life-

altering decisions, opening discussions on moral dilemmas and the justice system's demand for objective decisions despite emotional or societal pressures.

Notes

1 **Jury instructions** are a set of guidelines that a judge gives to a jury about the law that applies to a case. The purpose of jury instructions is to help the jury reach a verdict that follows the law.

2 The **jury room** is a private room adjacent to a courtroom, where a trial jury discusses a case and reaches its verdict.

3 A **court reporter** is a trained professional who writes down every word spoken during a court case. They create complete, word-for-word records of what judges, lawyers, and witnesses say.

*** T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 **Yet, even if you are against going, should you one day receive the same orderly missive I had in my hands, it's unlikely you'll be able to dodge it. (Para. 2)**

Meaning: Even if you don't want to go, if you receive the same official notice I did, it's unlikely you'll be able to avoid it.

should: *v.* (*modal verb*) used after "if" or instead of "if" for describing a situation that may possibly happen 如果；假如
Should you decide to attend, we would be happy to welcome you.

Note: The structure "should you …" is an inverted construction often used in formal or hypothetical contexts. It means "if you" but is more conditional and formal. This construction is often used in written language, legal contexts, or formal communication to present hypothetical scenarios in a polite or elevated tone.

dodge:
vt. deliberately avoid discussing sth. or doing sth. （故意）避开，避免（谈论某事或做某事）
He managed to dodge the question by changing the subject.

v. move quickly to avoid sb. or sth. （快速）躲开，避开
She dodged the ball just in time.

Note: "Dodge" can be used both in a physical sense (dodging an object) and in a more metaphorical sense (avoiding a responsibility or question). It is also used in everyday conversation with a slightly informal tone, though its usage in formal contexts can imply a calculated or intentional avoidance.

2 **If you dread the prospect, take solace in the fact that the Ministry of Justice estimates that there is only a 35 or so percent chance of any one person being selected in their entire lifetime, and barely more than half of those will actually end up on a jury. (Para. 2)**

Meaning: If you're worried about being called for jury duty, take comfort in knowing that the Ministry of Justice estimates the likelihood of any individual being selected for jury duty in their lifetime is only around 35 percent, and just over half of those selected will actually serve on a jury.

3 **As luck would have it, I was the eighth to be dubbed a "winner" of the jury prize draw. (Para. 4)**

as luck would have it: used to say that sth. happened by chance 碰巧；真幸运
As luck would have it, the rain stopped right when we reached the park.

Note: This phrase is often used in informal or conversational language to describe events or situations that seem governed by fate or chance, especially when something ironic happens unexpectedly.

dub: *vt.* (*usu. passive*) give sth. or sb. a name that describes them in some way 把…称为；给…起绰号
He was dubbed the "King of Pop" because of his musical influence.

4 **It's one thing to read about criminals being sent down and perhaps think you'd have no problem condemning them to the rest of their lives behind bars; they may apparently deserve it and their guilt may seem certain. But when faced with the harsh reality of it there right in front of you, it's an entirely different situation. (Para. 6)**

It's one thing to ..., (it's) another thing to ...: used to say that doing one thing is very different from doing another thing, esp. where the second thing is more difficult, important, or serious …是一回事，…是另一回事
It's one thing to read about healthy diets, but another to follow them.

Note: This structure is often used to show that a situation is easier in theory than in practice. It draws attention to the gap between reading or thinking about something and actually doing or experiencing it. It's a common construction in conversational English, particularly in contexts where someone might feel confident in their opinions but might act differently when faced with a real situation.

send down: (*BrE*) (*infml.*) send sb. to prison 送某人进监狱
He was sent down for five years for his involvement in the fraud.

Note: This phrase is used informally, typically in casual or journalistic contexts. It is mostly used in British English and may not be as common in American English, where the term "sent to prison" or "sentenced to jail" is preferred. It's useful in discussions about legal consequences and punishments.

behind bars: (*infml.*) in prison 坐牢

The documentary sheds light on the lives of those who have spent decades behind bars.

Note: The phrase "behind bars" is a common metaphor for prison. It's a visual image, evoking the idea of being physically confined by prison bars.

5 Doubt creeps in. (Para. 6)

creep in: gradually start to be noticeable 逐渐显现；逐渐引起注意

As she thought more about the decision, hesitation crept in, making her unsure of what to do next.

Note: This phrase is often used in situations where uncertainty or fear arises gradually. It's a useful expression when describing emotions or psychological states that develop over time and are not immediately obvious. It helps convey the idea that doubt is something that can subtly undermine confidence or decision-making.

6 You listen to every word; you realize someone's future is on the line, but equally difficult is that acquitting them is effectively telling their accusers, "We don't believe you." (Para. 6)

on the line: at risk 处于危险之中；受到威胁；岌岌可危

His job is on the line if he doesn't meet his targets this quarter.

acquit: *vt.* (*usu. passive*) give a decision in a court of law that sb. is not guilty of a crime 宣判…无罪

Despite the overwhelming evidence, he was acquitted on the grounds of insufficient evidence.

Note: Notice how the sentence contrasts two difficult aspects of decision-making using "but" and "equally difficult." It effectively demonstrates the tension between these challenges and shows how to structure sentences that present contrasting ideas. In legal contexts, "acquitting" is a formal term meaning clearing someone of charges. It carries significant moral and legal implications, as highlighted in this sentence.

7 Through every emotional witness called to the stand, each 45-minute speech delivered by the prosecution and defence barristers, not to mention the line-by-line analysis of police interviews, any doubts I had about the legitimacy of the jury system in the modern age dissipated like morning fog. (Para. 7)

Note: The sentence is complex and cumulative, combining multiple descriptive phrases that build on one another to convey a gradual shift in the narrator's perspective. It begins with a series of actions / events ("witnesses," "speeches," "analyses"), which collectively lead to a result ("the dissipation of doubts"). The sequence of events builds toward the conclusion, where the narrator reflects on the change in her perception of the jury system. The use of prepositional phrases ("through," "by") helps to structure the progression of events, creating a sense of anticipation or suspense before revealing the outcome.

Translation

司法的背后——我的陪审员经历

1 一天下午，当我正在翻看一叠看似常规的邮件时，发现了一个看起来相当正式的信封，上面写着“英国皇家法院及法庭服务处”的字样。信封里是一张传票，要求我履行陪审员义务，约七周后前往地方法院参与可能持续十天甚至更久的陪审工作。

2 我屡次听到人们抱怨被传唤担任陪审员——既耽误工夫，又影响工作收入，诸如此类。然而，即便你不愿意去，如果某一天你也收到了像我手中那样的正式公函，你也很难逃避。凡年满 18 周岁的公民都随时可能会被传召——这是从选民名册中随机抽取的——如今只有少数几种情况可构成合理的豁免理由，例如在刑事司法系统工作。若 y 遇到与你长期计划的假期冲突等情形，你可以申请延期履行；但其他唯一的逃避方式就是你是被定罪的罪犯。如果你对这一前景感到畏惧，可以安慰自己，据司法部估计，一个人一生中被选中担任陪审员的概率只有大约 35%，而其中只有过半的人最终会成为真正的陪审员。

3 那一天终于到来了。我沿着市政厅街漫步，随意走进了那个未知的世界。法院工作人员态度友好、语气轻松地迎接我们这些准陪审员，并检查是否所有人都到齐。通常会有几个备用陪审员，以防最终的 12 名陪审员出现任何问题。

4 我们坐在长椅上，随后被指示，如果我们的名字从抽签箱中被抽中，就到陪审席就座。法官告诉我们，如果没有被选中也不要感到沮丧。运气不错，我是第八个被抽中的“幸运儿”。

5 在听取了陪审团指示后，我们便立即投入庭审。这是一起无论从哪个角度看都特别恶劣的案件，以我日常接触社交媒体暴民的经验，绝对是那种会让很多人从第一分钟开始就愤怒不已、疯狂敲击键盘打出“绞死他们”的案件。

6 我曾也会不假思索地认为被告有罪，但一旦成为司法系统的一部分，我的整个观点都发生了转变。在新闻报道中读到罪犯被判刑时，你可能会觉得判处他们终身监禁没什么困难——他们似乎是罪有应得，而罪行似乎也确凿无疑。然而，当这种残酷的现实活生生展现在你面前时，情况就完全不同了。怀疑悄悄滋生。你仔细听每一个字，意识到某人的未来就掌握在你的手中，但同样艰难的是，如果判其无罪，就相当于告诉控方：“我们不相信你”。

7 每一位陪审员都显然以同样严肃的态度对待这项任务。通过每一位情绪激动的证人证言，控辩双方律师每一场 45 分钟的陈述，更不用说对警方讯问

记录的逐字逐句分析，我对现代陪审制度合理性的所有疑虑都如晨雾般消散。

8 当双方都已陈述完毕，法官详细总结证据后，我们退回陪审团评议室开始讨论案件。我们认真对待这一任务，仔细审查证据，反复查阅笔记，还请法庭书记员进来，让我们再次听取某些证词。整个过程严格限制在陪审团评议室内，不受任何外界干扰。我们的讨论内容永远不得外泄，我们也无须以任何方式为我们的裁决提供理由。经过一整天的审议，我们最终达成了裁决。

9 我们最后一次列队走进法庭时，被告、辩护律师和控方都站了起来。宣读完裁决结果，法官感谢我们为司法服务。就这样，为期十天的陪审员工作画上句号。

10 回望这段经历，我由衷庆幸自己被选中履行作为公民的责任。陪审工作既富有教育意义，又令人受益匪浅。当一切结束时，我感觉自己确实有所作为，成为了某种更崇高事业的一部分。这段陪审员经历让我重新认识到司法系统的公正严明，以及司法工作者的责任担当与专业精神。

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) 18
2) randomly
3) a summons
4) dodge
5) 12

2

The correct order is: b, c, e, a, d

3

1 On the way to the court, the author feels casual and somewhat indifferent, as reflected by the sentence, “I strolled down Town Hall Street and casually walked into the unknown.” However, after being chosen as one of the 12 jurors, the author seems to feel a mix of surprise and perhaps subdued satisfaction, as she describes being the “eighth to be dubbed a ‘winner’ of the jury prize draw.” There is no strong sense of dread or excitement but rather a sense of inevitability and responsibility.

2 From a non-juror perspective, the author initially feels strongly influenced by the social media mob mentality, where people quickly assume guilt and demand harsh punishment without fully understanding the facts. The author admits that, before becoming part of the judicial process, she would have instantly assumed guilt and reacted emotionally, similar to the online crowd. This perspective reflects a lack of critical evaluation and reliance on public sentiment rather than evidence.

3 The author takes her role as a juror very seriously. She recognizes the weight of the responsibility and reflects on the emotional impact of the case, noting how her perspective shifted from assuming guilt to experiencing doubt as the trial progressed. The author feels the burden of being part of the judicial process, understanding that the jury's verdict can affect someone's future. Throughout, she describes the process with a sense of duty and professionalism, emphasizing that every juror approached the task with seriousness and care.

4 The author reflects positively on the importance of the jury system, stating that it helped her appreciate its fairness and rigor. She mentions that her experience as a juror gave her a deeper understanding of the responsibility involved, as well as the professionalism of those who work within the system. The author concludes with a sense of fulfillment, feeling that her participation made a difference and that she was part of something bigger, which ultimately affirmed her belief in the integrity of the system.

Language in focus

1 Match the words in Column A with their definitions in Column B.

A	B
1 jury	a. a formal order to appear in court
2 prosecution	b. a formal statement that a person makes about what they saw someone do or what they know of a situation, after having promised to tell the truth
3 verdict	c. the long and careful consideration of a subject
4 deliberation	d. the fact of having committed a breach of conduct especially violating the law and involving a penalty
5 testimony	e. the quality or state of being legitimate
6 guilt	f. a body of persons sworn to give a verdict on some matter submitted to them
7 summons	g. the action of charging someone with a crime and putting them on trial
8 legitimacy	h. the finding or decision of a jury on the matter submitted to it in a trial

Reference answers

1 f

2 g

3 h

4 c

5 b

6 d

7 a

8 e

2 Complete the sentences with the correct form of the words in Column A.

1 These are both entirely _____ military objectives under the laws of armed conflict, as they align with internationally recognized standards for warfare.

2 He pleaded guilty to nine federal tax charges just before _____ selection for his trial was scheduled to begin in California.

3 I was handed a(n)_____ to appear for jury duty, and I immediately wondered if I would be selected.

4 We see the logic behind withholding the names of very young offenders _____of lesser crimes.

5 Prosecutors may try to determine if Rob gave false _____ when he appeared before the grand jury.

6 Wiley instructed the jurors to make every possible effort to reach a unanimous _____.

7 There have been cases where tourists who took part in the protests have been arrested and _____ for that.

8 In the first trial, the jury _____ for more than 25 hours over four days.

Reference answers

1 legitimate

2 jury

3 summons

4 guilty

5 testimony

6 verdict

7 prosecuted

8 deliberated

3 Paraphrase the sentences, paying attention to the underlined words.

1 If you dread the prospect, take solace in the fact that the Ministry of Justice estimates that there is only a 35 or so percent chance of any one person being selected in their entire lifetime.

2 You listen to every word; you realize someone's future is on the line.

3 By the time both sides had presented their cases and the judge had summed up the evidence at length, we retired to the jury room to discuss the case.

Reference answers

1 If the idea worries you, take comfort in knowing that the Ministry of Justice estimates there is only about a 35% chance of any individual being chosen for jury duty in their lifetime.

2 You pay close attention to every word, understanding that someone's future is at stake.

3 Once both sides had presented their arguments and the judge had thoroughly reviewed the evidence, we moved to the jury room to deliberate on the case.

Live interview

Teaching suggestions

This task helps Ss practice structured speaking on legal topics while developing intercultural communication skills. It focuses on three key areas: access to legal services, the law's impact on daily life, and the role of citizens in promoting social justice. To support Ss, T can provide background on legal systems in other countries and encourage the use of transition phrases (e.g., first, in addition, on the one hand) for structured responses. Challenges may include expressing abstract concepts like justice or making meaningful comparisons. To address this, Ss can use simple, real-life examples. Overall, the activity fosters critical thinking and cultural awareness. As an extension, Ss can write a short comparison report or conduct a follow-up Q&A session based on their role-play.

Sample answers

Host: Good evening, and welcome to Law and Life! I'm joined by two distinguished guests: Mr. Li from China and Mr. Johnson from the UK. Tonight, we'll be discussing how legal systems and access to justice differ between their countries. Let's dive right in. Mr. Li, how do people in China access legal information and services?

Mr. Li: In China, there are several ways people can access legal information and services. For example, we have government websites and mobile apps where people can find laws and regulations easily. Additionally, the legal aid system supports those who cannot afford legal representation. Local legal advice stations have also been set up in many communities, offering free consultations. And, of course, there's a strong

presence of law firms that provide paid legal services for more specialized needs.

Host: That's very informative. Mr. Johnson, how does the situation compare in the UK? How do people access legal information and services there?

Mr. Johnson: In the UK, legal information is mainly available through online resources, such as government websites, where people can find comprehensive guides on a wide range of legal issues. We also have a robust system of Citizens Advice Bureaus, where people can go for free and impartial advice. Legal services are generally provided by solicitors. The legal aid system exists for individuals who meet specific eligibility criteria, making sure legal help isn't limited to the wealthy.

Host: It seems like both countries have accessible systems, though in different ways. Now, let's move on to the next question. Mr. Li, how does the law affect daily life and decision-making for individuals in China?

Mr. Li: In China, the law plays a significant role in shaping people's daily lives. For instance, laws around property, contracts, and labor rights influence personal decisions like buying a home, starting a business, or choosing a career path. The recently introduced Civil Code further emphasizes the protection of individual rights, including privacy and data security. The law also governs public services in health, education, and social welfare, making it a guiding factor in personal decision-making.

Host: That's interesting! Mr. Johnson, how does the law impact people's daily lives in the UK?

Mr. Johnson: In the UK, the law influences many aspects of daily life, ranging from family matters like marriage and divorce to employment or consumer rights. For example, employment laws help ensure fair pay and protection against discrimination, influencing workplace decisions. Consumer protection laws give people confidence when they buy goods and services. The law in the UK also safeguards personal freedoms and rights in public spaces.

Host: It's fascinating to see how legal frameworks shape lives in different ways. Finally, let's talk about the role of ordinary citizens. Mr. Li, what role do ordinary citizens in China play in promoting and maintaining social justice?

Mr. Li: Chinese citizens participate actively in promoting social justice, especially through grassroots organizations and community legal stations. People are encouraged to report legal violations and seek justice for themselves and others. Additionally, China has implemented various public legal education programs to raise awareness of citizens' rights and responsibilities. Moreover, citizens are increasingly involved in providing feedback on legal reforms and policies, contributing to judicial review and fairness.

Host: That's a powerful role! Mr. Johnson, what about in the UK? How do ordinary citizens contribute to social justice?

Mr. Johnson: In the UK, citizens also play an essential role in promoting social justice. For instance, they can participate in public consultations regarding new laws or

amendments to existing ones. Public campaigns, activism, and the work of charities and NGOs are crucial in raising awareness about social justice issues. Furthermore, the right to vote and involvement in local government enable citizens to shape policies that protect vulnerable groups in society. Citizens can also act as jurors in the judicial system, ensuring that justice is served fairly.

Host: It's clear that in both countries, the role of ordinary citizens is crucial for promoting fairness and social justice. Thank you, Mr. Li and Mr. Johnson, for sharing your valuable insights. It's been a pleasure discussing these important topics with both of you!

Communicating with the world

Additional notes

To create a compelling publicity video on China's rule of law, Ss should focus on delivering a clear, engaging message. Start by highlighting key topics such as legal reforms, public participation in lawmaking, and technological advances like online courts. Present these themes in a way that connects with universal principles of justice and fairness, making them relevant to an international audience. The video should open with a strong hook, like an intriguing question or fact, to capture attention. The script should focus on two or three key points, such as legislative contact stations and the Civil Code, using concrete examples to show their impact on daily life. Storytelling is essential – relatable anecdotes can emotionally connect viewers to the message. Visuals must support the message, using footage of legislative activities, everyday scenarios, or legal technologies. The on-screen text should emphasize key points, while clear narration and well-paced background music could be used to enhance the viewer's experience. Conclude with a strong, memorable statement that reinforces the importance of China's legal advancements in building a fairer, safer society. This approach will help Ss create an informative and impactful video.

For evaluation, focus on content relevance, structure, language clarity, visual alignment, and cultural engagement.

***Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

Title: **China's path to the rule of law: Building a fair and just society**
[Scene 1: Opening]
Narration:
In a country of over 1.4 billion people, the rule of law shapes how daily life unfolds – how we interact, how we live, and how we work. But how did this transformation take place in China, and what's next for its legal system?

[Scene 2: Citizen engagement in lawmaking]
Narration:
One of China's key achievements has been bringing the law closer to the people. Just like the UK's jury system, where citizens actively participate in trials, China encourages its citizens to take part in lawmaking through grassroots channels. At places like the Hongqiao legislative contact station, citizens can directly engage with lawmaking – offering suggestions, raising concerns, and even pushing for change. This unique approach fosters a sense of ownership and responsibility in the process of lawmaking.

[Scene 3: Legal advancements for the modern age]
Narration:
A major step forward in China's legal development is the Civil Code – the country's first unified civil code, enacted in 2021. It brings together laws on property, personality rights, contracts, and more into one comprehensive system. Covering nearly every aspect of civil life, the Code strengthens legal protections, reflects modern social needs, and marks a key moment in building a fair, well-ordered society under the rule of law.

[Scene 4: Technology and the judiciary]
Narration:
China has also embraced technology to enhance its legal system. From online courts to AI-assisted legal tools, innovations are making the judicial process faster, more efficient, and more accessible to everyone. These technological advancements are not only improving how the law is applied – they're improving how citizens access and understand the law, breaking down the barriers to justice.

[Scene 5: Impact on daily life]
Narration:
The impact of these advancements is felt daily. From ensuring safe public spaces to addressing issues like digital privacy and property rights, China's rule of law is transforming the lives of its people. For example, in cities across China, smartphone apps now help people settle disputes, file complaints, and access legal services without leaving home. Whether it's resolving a neighborhood conflict or claiming unpaid wages, these tools make justice faster and easier to reach. It's through changes like these that legal reform becomes real, shaping a fairer, more secure society for everyone.

[Scene 6 Conclusion]
Narration:
As China continues to develop, its legal system moves with it, creating a society built on fairness, security, and shared responsibility. The rule of law is no longer just a concept; it's a way of life that empowers every citizen. Together, we're building a future of justice, equality, and opportunity.

Self-reflection

Understanding China	1	I can describe the ways in which the law is popularized in China.
	2	I can provide examples of how technology facilitates the delivery of legal services.
	3	I can explain how the public participates in law-making.
	4	I can identify laws designed to address the challenges of a rapidly advancing society.
	5	I can discuss the significance of the Civil Code.
Exploring the world	1	I can describe how jurors are selected in the UK.
	2	I can explain how the jury performs its duty at a trial.
	3	I can discuss how jury trials help to maintain justice.
Communicating with the world	1	I can use effective questions in my publicity video.
	2	I can incorporate cross-cultural comparisons in my publicity video.